Mira Chami

Gameplay Programmer

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Gameplay programmer prototyping AI-native games: LLM-driven game direction, knowledge-grounded AI characters, server-authoritative multiplayer and designer tooling across Godot, Unreal Engine 5 and Unity. Shipped mobile titles and led programming on a Unity prototype.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Tencent

Nov 2023 – Present

Game Tech R&D Engineer (Gameplay, Multiplayer & AI) · London, UK

Extraction Game & Applied AI

Godot, GDScript

- Designed and built the gameplay interface an LLM game director uses to shape co-op runs like an AI Dungeon Master: a validated action library for spawning enemies, rewarding players with items and changing progression. Actions execute through server-authoritative systems, so model decisions never touch networked state directly.
- Built a timeline runtime and Godot editor plugin so designers can author, preview and validate the same typed actions without code, letting AI-director behaviours be prototyped by hand before the model drives them.
- Architected server-authoritative co-op multiplayer (Steam P2P, LAN, listen and dedicated servers) with replication, RPCs, sessions and local multi-client testing.
- Built data-driven co-op runs and UI covering objectives, death and revival, node/map selection, currency, rewards and win/loss conditions, configurable by designers.
- Profiled procedural generation and frame-rate issues in Godot, identifying CPU-bound bottlenecks.

Investigative Game & Applied AI

Godot, Gemini, Node.js

- Built the core loop of an investigation game where players review case files, connect evidence on a board and question AI witnesses who answer only from their character’s knowledge; a verification step checks replies before players see them.
- Turned player choices into AI input: players pin up to three evidence cards and pick an intent (ask, challenge, connect) to build a question. Owned the evidence-board, case-file and interview UI.
- Kept the AI flows responsive and testable: session caching, timeouts, cancellation and retries for asynchronous interviews; Gemini/Search-grounded case generation with schema validation; UI tests with mocked model replies across screen sizes.

InGame Integration & Multiplayer Demo

UE5, C++, Blueprints

- Built replicated multiplayer gameplay in UE5 using C++ and Blueprints, including character state, team rules, scoring, interactables and match transitions.
- Integrated InGame, Tencent’s public online services framework, into a multiplayer demo to demonstrate and validate authentication, lobbies, matchmaking, quests, progression, inventory and achievements; owned the demo’s UI.
- Implemented PlayStation 5 support and dedicated-server debugging in Unreal Editor; supported partner studios with gameplay, plugin and backend integration; modified CI pipelines.

Desktop AI Companion

React, Rust, Tauri

- Led the Electron vs Tauri evaluation with working prototypes and migrated the client to Tauri v2, keeping it lightweight while running alongside games.
- Built streaming AI chat (HTTP/SSE, progressive rendering) across full-chat and in-game companion modes, with overlays, hotkeys, persistent history and automated Windows/macOS builds.

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

The Video Games Studio (VGS)

Jun 2020 – Aug 2022

Game Programmer · Beirut, Lebanon

- Led programming for a Unity adventure prototype, translating the game design into character, ability and interaction systems; built touch controls with the Unity Input System alongside level designers.
- Owned gameplay architecture for a published Unity puzzle game: adventure and drawing modes sharing progression and saves, with player-created levels that can be saved and replayed.
- Developed and shipped a mobile runner: gameplay, difficulty balancing, monetisation and PlayFab competitions, plus a tool to run competition cycles and retrieve winners.
- Built configurable difficulty, progression and shop content with ScriptableObjects; integrated Unity UI, PlayFab, third-party plugins and backend services.
- Supported technical interviews, onboarded and mentored developers, ran code reviews and planned tasks in Jira and Trello; contributed to game design documents and technical documentation.

TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

Engines & Gameplay:
Unreal Engine 5 · Unity · Godot · Blueprints · Data-Driven Gameplay · ScriptableObjects

Multiplayer & Services:
Server-Authoritative Multiplayer · Replication · RPCs · Dedicated/Listen Servers · Steamworks · InGame · PlayFab · Photon PUN 2 · Node.js · Express · gRPC/Protobuf

Languages:
C++ · C# · GDScript · Python · TypeScript · Rust · JavaScript · Java · C

Applied AI:
LLM Integration · LLM Tool Design · Google Search Grounding · Structured Outputs (JSON Schema) · LLM Output Validation

Development Tools:
Godot Editor Plugins · Git · Perforce · CI · Automated Testing · Build & Release Automation · Performance Profiling

Desktop & Graphics:
React · Tauri · Electron · Three.js · PixiJS · Unity URP · Native API Integration

EDUCATION

MSc Games Development (Programming) · Kingston University London · 2022 – 2023

BSc Computer Science · American University of Beirut · 2017 – 2021

BA Economics · American University of Beirut · 2016 – 2020

MISCELLANEOUS

Languages: English, French, Arabic (all native)

Favourite games: Clair Obscur: Expedition 33 · Celeste · Split Fiction · The Last of Us · Outer Wilds